Ideation Phase
Define the Problem Statements

Date	05 Apr. 26
Team ID	SWTID-2026-6042
Project Name	Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement:

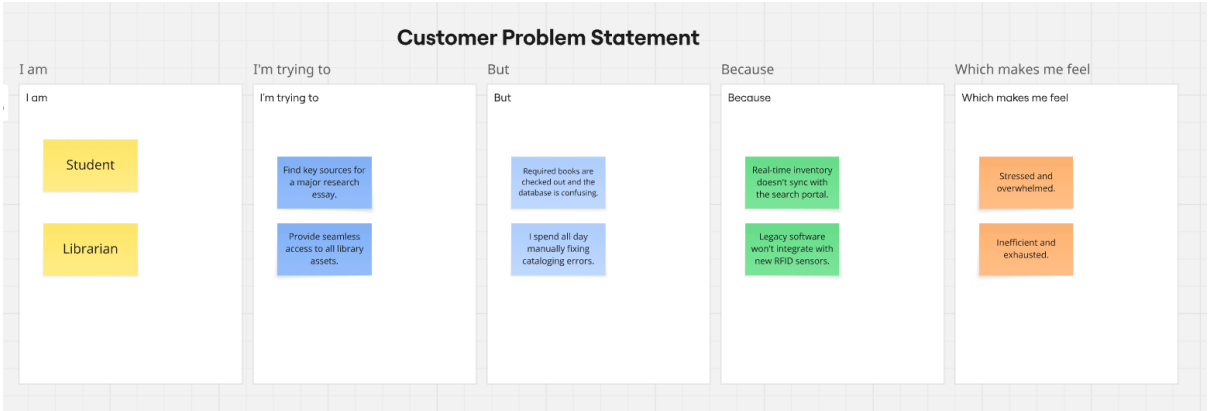
Create a problem statement to understand your customer's point of view. The Customer Problem Statement template helps you focus on what matters to create experiences people will love.

A well-articulated customer problem statement allows you and your team to find the ideal solution for the challenges your customers face. Throughout the process, you'll also be able to empathize with your customers, which helps you better understand how they perceive your product or service.

Student:

- **I am** a college student who needs to borrow books for research and coursework.
- **I am trying to** easily find available books and submit a request without manual paperwork or visiting the library multiple times.
- **But** I currently have no way to see if a book is already issued to someone else before I try to request it.
- **Which makes me feel** frustrated and slows down my research progress.
- **My ideal solution is** a digital platform where I can see real-time book availability and receive instant confirmation when my request is approved.

Librarian:

- **I am** a library administrator responsible for managing a growing catalog of books.
- **I am trying to** track which books are issued, which are available, and ensure that only authorized students are borrowing materials.
- **But** manually updating book statuses and managing paper request forms is time-consuming and prone to human error.
- **Which makes me feel** overwhelmed by administrative tasks rather than focusing on helping students.
- **My ideal solution is** an automated system that handles approvals, updates inventory status instantly, and provides reports on the most popular books.

I am	Describe customer with 3-4 key characteristics - *who are they?*	A dedicated PhD candidate in History, deeply focused on a specific archival project. Time-sensitive and relies heavily on a mix of rare physical monographs and I also need robust, real-time research assistance from **subject matter librarians** who are often stretched thin, partiing peak thesis season. I prefer streamlined, digital-first interactions.
I'm trying to	List their *outcome* or *"job" the care about - what are they trying to achieve?*	Locate and access very specific, multi-volume text series, ensure they are checked Access specialized archives on weekends when the physical library is closed, ensure my inter-library loan requests are prioritized, and connect with other researchers working in my field for collaboration.
but	Describe what problems or barriers stand in the way – *what bothers them most?*	The inter-library loan tracking system has poor visibility, often leaving me unaware of where critical resources are. The physical archives require an in-person, pre-booked appointment that takes weeks to secure, and there's no way to easily find collaboration partners on-campus.
because	Enter the "root cause" of why the problem or barrier exists – *what needs to be solved?*	Archival digitization efforts are severely underfunded and lack a clear priority roadmap. The inter-library loan platform is a legacy system with no modern user-facing API, and there is no centralized, privacy-respecting user directory for research profiles and connections.
which makes me feel	Describe the emotions from the customer's point of view – *how does it impact them emotionally?*	Increasingly desperate and isolated. I am spending critical research time on administrative and logistical issues that the technology was supposed to solve. I worry that without these resources, the depth and quality of my thesis will be compromised, leading to profound professional anxiety.